INCH-POUND

MIL-N-43741B
30 AUG 1989
SUPERSEDING
MIL-N-43741A
14 June 1983

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

NECKERCHIEF, MAN'S, COTTON, KNITTED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type and size of a man's neckerchief made from cotton knitted cloth.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-50083 - Bag, Plastic, Folded Garment
V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development and Engineeering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8440

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DDD-L-20 - Label; For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use)
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage, General Specification For

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods
FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF TEXTILE CHEMISTS AND COLORISTS (AATCC)

Chromatic Transference Scale

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists, Research Triangle Park, P.O. Box 12215, Research Triangle Park, NC 27709-2215.)

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THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES, INC.

Standard Color Card of America

Department of Defense Standard Shades for Sewing Threads

(Color cards may be available from the Color Association of the United States, Inc., 343 Lexington Avenue, New York, NY 10016-0927. If color cards are not available from the Color Association, individual color samples may be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Samples.

3.1.1 Guide sample. Guide samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information (see 6.4). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.1.2 Standard sample. The dyed cloth shall match the standard sample for shade appearance and shall be equal to or better than the standard sample with respect to all characteristics for which the standard sample is referenced (see 6.4).

3.1.3 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.3) in accordance with 4.3.

3.2 Material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this specification.

3.2.1 Cloth. The cloth for the neckerchief shall be a knitted cloth made from cotton yarn. The cloth shall be circular knit with a flat (jersey) stitch having a minimum of 28 wales and 25 courses per inch, a minimum weight of 2.5 ounces per square yard, and a minimum bursting strength of 35 pounds. Testing shall be as specified in 4.4.4.

3.2.1.1 Nonfibrous material content. The starch and protein content, including chloroform-soluble material of the finished cloth, shall not exceed 6.0 percent, when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

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3.2.1.2 Color. The color of the knitted cloth shall be Brown 436 (see 6.6). The use of dyes and compounds containing elementary sulfur capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The dyestuff shall be chosen and applied so that the dyed and finished cloth shall contain no more labile sulfur than shown by the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.4.4. When a standard sample is not available, the finished cloth shall show no more than a slight trace of labile sulfur as defined in the test method as specified in 4.4.4.

3.2.1.2.1 Matching. The color of the finished cloth shall match the standard sample when viewed under filtered tungsten lamps that approximate artificial daylight and that have a correlated color temperature of 7500 $\pm$ 200 K, with illumination of 100 $\pm$ 20 foot candles and shall be a good match to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2300 $\pm$ 200 K.

3.2.1.2.2 Colorfastness. The dyed cloth shall show colorfastness to laundering (after 3 cycles), light, perspiration, and crocking equal to or better than the standard sample (see 6.4) or shall show "good" fastness to laundering (after 3 cycles), light, and perspiration, and shall show an AATCC Chromatic Transference Scale rating for crocking not lower than 3.5. Testing shall be as specified in 4.4.4.

3.2.1.3 pH. The pH of the water extract of the finished cloth shall be no less than 5.0 nor more than 8.5 when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

3.2.2 Thread. The thread for overedge stitching shall be cotton, type IA3, ticket No. 70, 3 ply of V-T-276, dyed to match Khaki P-1, C.A. 66019.

3.2.3 Label. The identification label shall conform to type III or IV, class 1 of DDD-L-20. The label shall show fastness to laundering.

3.3 Design and sizes. The neckerchief shall be a single layer of the knitted cloth, with raw edges overedge stitched. Finished dimensions shall be 72 $\pm$ 1 inches by 24 $\pm$ 1 inches.

3.4 Construction.

3.4.1 Manufacturing operations requirements. The neckerchiefs shall be manufactured in accordance with the operation requirements specified in table I. The contractor is not required to follow the exact sequence of operations.

3.4.2 Stitches and stitchings. Stitches and stitching types specified in table I shall conform to FED-STD-751. When two or more stitch types are given for the same part of the operation, any one of them may be used.

3.4.2.1 Stitches per inch. The minimum and maximum number of stitches per inch shall be as specified in table I.

3.4.2.2 Thread breaks. Thread breaks shall be securely stitched back of the break not less than 1/2 inch.

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TABLE I.

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
1.	Cutting. Cut the neckerchief to finish 72 ± 1 inches by 24 ± 1 inches.						
2.	Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.2 shall be removed from production and replaced with non-defective and properly matched components.						
3.	Overedge stitching. Finished appearance. When a knife is used on an overedging machine, care shall be exercised that the edge of the fabric is not cut off but the raw edge is trimmed.						
	Overedge stitch the four raw edges of neckerchief.	502 or	EFd-1	6-10	70-3	70-3	
	The gage of stitching shall be 1/8 to 3/16 inch.	503	EFd-1	6-10	70-3	70-3	
	The ends of stitching shall overlap 3/4 to 1-1/4 inches.	504 or	EFd-1	6-10	70-3	70-3	70-3
		505	EFd-1	6-10	70-3	70-3	70-3
4.	Label (see 3.2.3). Position the label on the back side of neckerchief 1 ± 1/8 inches from one of the four corners.						

NATICK Form 903
1 Dec 76 EDITION OF 1 OCT 76 WILL BE USED UNTIL EXHAUSTED.

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3.5 Workmanship. The finished neckerchief shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to the requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of know defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for ensuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to ensure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.1.3 Certificates of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 3.1.3 and 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in table II and 4.4.3 and tested for the characteristics specified in table III.

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.2 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one neckerchief. The sample unit shall be one neckerchief. The inspection level shall be I (see 6.7).

TABLE II. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect
Material defects and workmanship damages	Hole, cut, tear, run, drop stitch, or needle chew. Any thin area, mend, or slub. Shade not comparable to standard or approved sample. Streak, stain, shade bar, spot, or shaded, clearly noticeable.
Seams and stitching	Wrong seam type. Wrong stitching type. Twisted, puckered, or pleated affecting appearance. Ends of overedge stitching not overlapping or overlapping less than 3/4 inch or more than 1-1/4 inches. Gage of stitching not as specified. Two or more skipped stitches or one or more broken stitches. Thread breaks backstitched less than 1/2 inch. Loose tension resulting in loosely secured stitching. Stitches per inch less than minimum or more than maximum specified.
Label (marking)	Omitted, incorrect, or illegible. Positioned less than 7/8 inch or more than 1-1/8 inches from one of the four corners. Not applied on the back side of the cloth.

4.4.3 End item dimensional examination. The end item sample shall be conditioned in a normal atmosphere in a relaxed state for a minimum of 1 hour and then examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be

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expressed in units of one neckerchief. The sample unit shall be one neckerchief. The inspection level shall be S-3 (see 6.7).

Defects

Lengthwise dimension is less than 71 inches or more than 73 inches.

Widthwise dimension is less than 23 inches or more than 25 inches.

4.4.4 End item testing. The end items shall be tested for the characteristics indicated in table III. The methods of testing specified in FED-STD-191 wherever applicable and as listed in table III shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the number of test specimens selected for a sample unit for test purposes, as specified in the applicable test method. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final results. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one neckerchief. The sample unit shall be one neckerchief. The sample size shall be as follows and the lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any requirement specified.

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

TABLE III. End item tests

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method
Material identification	3.2.1	1/
Type of knit	3.2.1	Visual
Wales and courses	3.2.1	5070
Bursting strength (pounds)	3.2.1	5120
Weight	3.2.1	5041
Nonfibrous material	3.2.1.1	2611
Labile sulfur	3.2.1.2	2020

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TABLE III. End item tests (cont'd)

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method
Colorfastness to:		
Laundering (after 3 cycles)	3.2.1.2.2	5610 2/
Light	3.2.1.2.2	5660
Crocking	3.2.1.2.2	5651
Perspiration	3.2.1.2.2	5680
pH	3.2.1.3	2811

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirement.

2/ The specimens shall be dried after each of the three laundering cycles.

4.4.5 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 (see 6.7).

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of polyethylene bagged unit packs per shipping container is more or less than specified. Number of neckerchiefs per polyethylene bag is more or less than specified. 1/

1/ For this defect, one polyethylene bagged unit pack shall be examined from each shipping container in the sample.

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4.4.6 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 (see 6.7).

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each neckerchief shall be folded to approximate dimensions of 9 by 6 inches. Six folded neckerchiefs of one class only shall be evenly stacked one on another and inserted in a snug-fitting flat or square style clear polyethylene film bag conforming to A-A-50083.

5.1.2 Commercial. Neckerchiefs shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. One hundred and forty-four neckerchiefs, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Level A unit packs shall be packed flat four in length, two in width, and three in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 24-1/2 inches in length, 18-1/2 inches in width, and 13-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished, as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5. Shipping

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containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. One hundred and forty-four neckerchiefs, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A unit packs shall be packed flat four in length, two in width, and three in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 24-1/2 inches in length, 18-1/2 inches in width, and 13-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard container. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Neckerchiefs preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), neckerchiefs, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV, or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C and D or film bonding means F and G. Pallet pattern shall be number 6 in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, unit packs, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

5.4.1 Polyethylene bagged unit packs. Polyethylene bagged unit packs shall have the required identification information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification.

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6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The neckerchiefs are intended for use by military personnel of the Department of Defense.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article sample is required (see 3.1.3, 4.3 and 6.3).
d. Levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.2.1).
f. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
g. When palletization is required (see 5.3).
h. Acceptance criteria required (see 6.7).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Samples. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.5 Knitted material. Material meeting the requirements of this specification was knitted on a 22-cut machine using 28/1 carded yarns.

6.6 Dyestuff combination. The following dye combination is suggested but not mandatory for shade Brown 436:

Reactive Yellow 84
Reactive Scarlet H-EA
Reactive Blue 160

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6.7 Acceptance criteria. The acceptance criteria below are recommended for use. The acceptance criteria as specified in the contract or purchase order shall be binding. Unless otherwise specified, the following acceptance criteria are in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

6.7.1 For end item visual examination. An acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 4.0 is recommended.

6.7.2 For end item dimensional examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 4.0 is recommended.

6.7.3 For packaging examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 2.5 is recommended.

6.7.4 For palletization examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 6.5 is recommended.

6.8 Subject term (key word) listing.

Neckwear

6.9 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8440-0178)

Review activities:

Army - MD
Air Force - 82
DLA - CT

User activities:

Air Force - 45
Navy - MC

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